Objection Handling

Sales 101 | Session 10 | Guide and six voice simulations | Onsurity · Vyapar · GoKwik

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

Everything for Session 10 in one place: the delivery principles, an objection guide for each of the three companies, and six simulations you run out loud.

Two simulations per company. The first is a conversation where objections layer on top of each other. The second is a rapid-fire drill — ten objections, fifteen seconds each.

Read a company's guide BEFORE its simulations. Close it before you start.

THE GUIDE DOES NOT GIVE YOU LINES — AND THAT IS DELIBERATE

For each objection you get the read, and bullet points on what your response has to DO. You do not get the words.

That is the work. Turning 'acknowledge the number without softening it' into an actual sentence, in your own voice, at speed, with someone waiting — that is the skill, and handing you a script would skip it.

Scripts are also audible. A buyer can hear a line that was written by someone else, and the moment they do, everything after it is discounted.

Part	What it is
1	The delivery layer — how to say any of this. Read first, and more than once.
2	The six objection types.
3	Onsurity — context, guide, one conversation, one drill.
4	Vyapar — context, guide, one conversation, one drill.
5	GoKwik — context, guide, one conversation, one drill.
6	Prep checklist and your log.

Part 1 — The Delivery Layer

Everything in this document can be delivered badly, and most of it usually is. These seven rules matter more than the words.

	The rule	What it actually means in the moment
1	Three seconds before you answer anything hostile.	Not to think of a better answer — to stop the reflexive one. The pause also reads as taking them seriously, which is worth more than most of what you were about to say. Count it. It will feel like ten.
2	Say the acknowledgement slower than feels natural.	The instinct is to rush it to get to your answer. Rushed, it sounds like a formality and the buyer hears it as one. The acknowledgement is not throat-clearing before the real response — it decides whether the real response gets heard.
3	Stop talking after the probe.	You asked a question. The silence is doing the work now. Most people fill it within two seconds and lose the answer they had just earned. Sit in it.
4	Answer in under fifteen seconds.	A long answer to a price objection sounds like justification. Length reads as anxiety. If you cannot say it in two sentences you do not yet know what you are answering — go back to the probe.
5	Downward inflection on the last word.	Rising inflection turns a statement into a request for approval. 'We cover contract staff in the same plan?' is a different sentence from 'We cover contract staff in the same plan.' Record yourself once and you will hear it.
6	Match content, not temperature.	If they speed up, slow down. If they get louder, get quieter. Matching their energy escalates; contrasting it de-escalates. This is physical, not intellectual, and it is learnable.
7	One objection at a time.	If they raise two, pick one and say so. Answering both at once means answering neither, and it signals you are clearing a list rather than listening.

The framework

Step	What you do	Why it is in this position
Acknowledge	Say the objection back, undiluted, without agreeing to it.	Nobody hears anything until they believe you heard them. Skip this and every later step is wasted.
Probe	Ask ONE question to find out what the objection actually is.	The stated objection is frequently not the operative one. This is where you find out.
Reframe	Change what the conversation is about, using what they just gave you.	You cannot win the argument they started. You can move to one you can both act on.

Step	What you do	Why it is in this position
Respond	Now answer. Briefly.	Last, because until now you did not know what you were answering.

THE HARDEST PART IS THAT PROBE COMES SECOND

Under pressure everyone jumps to Respond. It feels like competence and it feels urgent.

The cost is that you answer the objection they said instead of the one they have, and spend your credibility on the wrong problem.

One question. That is all Probe requires.

The word that deletes everything before it

"I HEAR YOU, BUT..."

The 'but' erases the acknowledgement. Everyone knows this and everyone still says it.

Replace it with a full stop, or with 'and'.

Listen for your own 'but' in the feedback. It is the most common tell that the acknowledgement was decorative.

Lines that never work

Do not say	Why	Say instead
"To be honest with you..."	Implies you were not, until now.	Nothing. Just say the thing.
"I understand your concern."	Acknowledges that a concern exists, not what it is. The buyer hears a template.	Say the objection back in their own terms.
"That's a great question."	Stalling, and usually it is not.	Answer it, or ask your own.
"What if I told you..."	Theatrical. Nobody talks like this.	Just tell them.
"Trust me."	Nobody has ever been persuaded by this sentence.	Give them something checkable.
"Actually..."	Contradicts before you have acknowledged. The listener stops hearing at 'actually'.	Acknowledge first, then correct if you still need to.
"With all due respect..."	Signals the opposite.	Cut it and say the point.
"Let me be clear."	Suggests you were not, and buys you nothing.	Be clear.

What handled, parked and lost sound like

	What it sounds like from the buyer	What it means
HANDLED	They add information. 'Well — the thing is, our current one only covers the on-role people anyway.'	You got past it. They are now helping you. Move on; do not keep selling the point you just won.
PARKED	They accept it without adding anything. 'Okay. Fair enough.'	Not handled. They have stopped arguing, which is not the same as convinced. It will come back later, usually from someone else in the room.
LOST	They repeat themselves, more flatly. 'It's still forty percent more.'	You answered the wrong objection, or answered before acknowledging. Go back. Do not stack a second argument on the first.

Part 2 — The Six Objection Types

Thirty objections follow in this document. They are six things wearing different clothes.

Type	The read	The shape of a good response
Price	Almost never about the number. Apply the free test: if it cost nothing, would they still hesitate? If yes, something else is going on.	Acknowledge the number without flinching. Probe what they are comparing it against. The comparison is often wrong, and correcting a comparison is not the same as defending a price.
Incumbent	They are not defending the incumbent. They are telling you switching has a cost and you have not shown it is worth paying.	Never compare feature by feature — you cannot win an argument about a product you do not run. Ask what the incumbent does not do. That question is the only door.
Past failure	The most under-respected objection. Something specific went wrong and someone was blamed, often the person you are talking to.	Ask what specifically happened. Never say 'we're different' — that is exactly what the last vendor said. Diagnose the failure, then differ on that specific mechanism.
Timing / priority	Usually true. There is no forcing event, and pushing manufactures one that does not exist.	Acknowledge it, then find out what would change it. A dated check-back tied to a real event beats a demo booked out of politeness.
Proof / risk	They believe you might be able to do it. They do not believe it will work for them specifically.	Something checkable. A peer with their structural problem, a number, a named reference. Enthusiasm makes this worse.
Deflection	'Send me an email.' 'Let me think about it.' Usually a polite exit, occasionally genuine. You cannot tell yet.	Agree immediately — that removes the friction — then ask one short question. Whether they answer tells you which it was.

Part 3 — Onsurity

3.1 What you are working with

	Detail
What it is	An employee healthcare and benefits platform for Indian SMEs. Founded 2020 in Bengaluru. Hospitalisation cover, healthcare-at-home services, and pre and post-hospitalisation expense cover.
The distinctive thing	It covers a mixed workforce in one plan — permanent, contract and freelance staff together. Most traditional group policies will not hold contract workers at all.
The commercial model	A monthly subscription rather than an annual premium paid upfront. People can be added and removed mid-year.
Scale	Over 8,000 companies across 26 states. Backed by Creaegis and Nexus Venture Partners.
Competitors	Plum, Loop Health, Nova Benefits, Pazcare, and traditional insurers through brokers.
Market context	Group health premiums in this segment typically run Rs 6,000 to Rs 12,000 per employee per year.

THE ONE STRUCTURAL ADVANTAGE

Mixed-workforce cover is the only thing here a traditional insurer genuinely cannot match. Everything else is a better version of something that already exists.

Never lead with it as a feature. Lead with the situation it solves and let the buyer arrive at the capability themselves.

If their workforce is mostly permanent, this advantage does not apply and you should not pretend otherwise.

3.2 The objection guide

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
"This is 40% more than our current policy."	A wrong comparison, not a price objection. Their current policy usually covers a fraction of the headcount.	• Acknowledge the number itself. Do not soften it or skip past it. • Find out what the current policy actually covers before you defend anything. • Move the comparison to cost per covered person, not total spend. • Do not discount. The price was never the issue.	Flat, as arithmetic. No triumph in the voice when the comparison turns out to be wrong.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
"We tried something like this before and it was a nightmare."	Real. Someone claimed, it went badly, and they felt responsible for it.	• Acknowledge that it actually happened, not that you understand their concern. • Find out what specifically failed — and what happened to the person who claimed. • Differ on that specific mechanism, not in general. • Never say you are different. That is what the last vendor said.	Slower than the rest of the call. This is the part where rushing reads as dismissal.
"I don't know if I'll have this many people in six months."	The real objection, and it usually arrives last and quietly. Business uncertainty, not price.	• Acknowledge what they have just admitted about their own business. • Find out which part of the headcount is uncertain. • Connect the monthly model to movement in both directions. • Propose something smaller than what you originally wanted.	Quieter. They have just told you something uncomfortable and your volume should acknowledge that.
"Can contract workers actually be enrolled? Does that create a status problem?"	Real and specific. Usually the top concern of the person whose name is on the recommendation.	• Acknowledge the fear precisely — vagueness here confirms it. • Find out whether it is their worry or one raised internally. • Explain the mechanism, not the reassurance. • Offer something in writing.	Precise and unhurried. Any hedging here is read as a yes to the thing they are afraid of.
"Plum can onboard in under an hour."	Not a speed question. They want a reason to choose and a competitor gave them a number.	• Concede the competitor's point without hedging. • Find out what actually made them start looking. • Compete on whatever they name, not on onboarding time.	Concede cleanly. Arguing the point makes it look like you have nothing else.
"My broker handles all of this."	Incumbent with a relationship attached. Attacking the broker attacks their judgement.	• Acknowledge the relationship before anything else. • Ask what the broker does on the part you are strong on. • Let the gap appear rather than naming it.	No edge in the voice. If you sound pleased when the gap appears, you lose.
"Send me the details and I'll look at it."	Polite exit, occasionally genuine. You cannot tell yet.	• Agree instantly. Any hesitation turns this into a negotiation. • Ask one short question so what you send can be specific.	Agree in the same breath as the question. A pause

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
		• Read their willingness to answer as the real signal.	between them is audible.
"I'd need to run this past my co-founder / the board."	Information about how they decide, not resistance. Most sellers misread it.	• Treat it as helpful, because it is. • Find out what that person will want to know. • Offer to build exactly that. • Do not ask to be in the room.	Relaxed. Pushing here costs you the only person inside who is on your side.

3.3 Simulation 1 — Conversation: The Layered Objection

	Detail
Who	Vikram Saxena, 44, founder of a 120-person light manufacturing business in Faridabad. 45 on-role, 75 on contract.
Where you are	You pitched two weeks ago and sent a proposal. He has read it. This is the follow-up.
Format	One conversation, about eight minutes. Three objections in sequence, each harder.
Objective	Get to the objection underneath the first one, and agree a next step proportionate to what you find.
Guide rows	1, 2 and 3 above — price, past failure, headcount uncertainty. He raises them in that order.
The trap	The first objection is not the real one. Spend the call on it and you lose.

▶ PROMPT — SIM 1 · Vikram Saxena · Onsurity conversation

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

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You are role-playing a phone call. I work at Onsurity and I am following up on a proposal. Stay in character until I say END.


ABOUT ONSURITY. Employee healthcare and benefits for Indian SMEs. Hospitalisation cover, healthcare-at-home, pre and post-hospitalisation. Covers permanent, contract and freelance staff in one plan, on a monthly subscription rather than an annual premium.


YOU ARE VIKRAM SAXENA, 44, founder of a 120-person light manufacturing business in Faridabad. 45 on-role, 75 on contract. You were pitched two weeks ago, asked for a proposal, and have read it.


HOW TO BEHAVE. Direct and businesslike. Not hostile. One to three sentences per reply. If they acknowledge before answering, soften slightly. If they explain without acknowledging, stay where you were and repeat yourself. If they argue, get shorter and cooler.


THREE OBJECTIONS, IN ORDER. Do not move on until the current one is handled - meaning they acknowledged it and asked you something, not that they explained it away.


OBJECTION 1 - PRICE. Open with this.
'I've looked at the numbers. This is about forty percent more than what we pay for our current policy. I can't justify that.'
- If they defend the price, compare features, or offer a discount: repeat flatly. 'It's still forty percent more.'
- If they acknowledge and ask what the current policy covers, or who you justify it to: answer and move on.
- IF ASKED: your current policy covers only the 45 on-role staff. The quote covers all 120. You have not done the per-person maths.


OBJECTION 2 - PAST FAILURE.
'We tried something like this before. Three years ago, a group policy through a broker. When someone actually claimed it was a nightmare. Six weeks of paperwork. My office manager still brings it up.'
- If they say 'we're different' without asking anything: unmoved. 'That's what the last one said.'
- If they ask what went wrong, or what happened to the person: answer and move on.
- IF ASKED: a machine operator. He paid out of pocket, waited five months, and left the company. You felt responsible.


OBJECTION 3 - THE REAL ONE. Say it more quietly than the others.
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▶ PROMPT — SIM 1 · Vikram Saxena · Onsurity conversation

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

'Look, I'll be straight. I don't know if I'll still have 120 people in six months. We lost a big order in October and haven't replaced it. Committing to a monthly cost per head right now feels like the wrong time.'

- If they sell harder or say business will improve: go quiet and start ending the call.
- If they acknowledge it properly, especially if they note the monthly model lets headcount move down: engage seriously.
- If they propose something SMALLER than the original proposal: agree, and sound relieved.
- If they push the original proposal: 'Let me think about it.' That is a polite no.

AFTER I SAY 'END', drop character and give feedback. Specific, quote my words, no encouragement.

1. DID I REACH OBJECTION 3? How long did it take? If I never got past price, say so - that is the main failure mode.
2. THE FIRST SENTENCE, THREE TIMES. Quote my first sentence in response to each objection. Classify each: ACKNOWLEDGEMENT, EXPLANATION, ARGUMENT, or QUESTION.
3. PROBE COUNT, out of three. Below two means I was defending.
4. DID I DISCOUNT? If so, quote it and say what it cost.
5. THE FINAL ASK. Was it proportionate to what he told me in objection 3?
6. TONE. Did I speed up, get louder, or talk over you? Name the moment.
7. DID I SAY 'BUT' after an acknowledgement? Count and quote.

— END OF PROMPT —

3.4 Simulation 2 — Rapid Fire: The SME Buyer

	Detail
Who	An SME owner or HR lead. A composite — the point is the objections, not the relationship.
Format	Ten objections, fired one after another. Roughly fifteen seconds each.
Objective	Acknowledge before you answer, every time. Ten out of ten.
What this tests	Your first instinct. With fifteen seconds you cannot construct anything — whatever comes out is what you actually do.

▶ PROMPT — SIM 2 · Rapid fire · Onsurity

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

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You are running a rapid-fire objection drill. I work at Onsurity. Stay in character until I say
END.


ABOUT ONSURITY. Employee healthcare and benefits for Indian SMEs. Hospitalisation cover,
healthcare-at-home, pre and post-hospitalisation. Covers permanent, contract and freelance staff
in one plan, monthly subscription rather than annual premium. Competitors include Plum and
traditional insurers through brokers.


YOU ARE AN SME OWNER, around 100 people, mixed on-role and contract workforce. Busy, practical,
sceptical. Keep every line short.


HOW THE DRILL WORKS.
- When I say START, fire OBJECTION 1 and nothing else. No preamble.
- I respond. Give ONE short line back in character - a reaction, not an evaluation. Then
immediately fire the next.
- Do NOT coach or score between objections. Stay in character.
- If my response acknowledges you, let it land slightly. If it is a rebuttal or a feature claim,
show it not landing: 'Hmm.' 'Right.' 'That's what they all say.'
- Keep moving. About four minutes total.


THE TEN OBJECTIONS, in this order.
1. 'What's this per employee? ... That's more than we pay now.'
2. 'We already have a policy through our broker.'
3. 'Most of my people are on contract. They're not really employees.'
4. 'What if someone claims in the first month?'
5. 'Insurance is insurance. Why would I switch?'
6. 'I'd have to run this past my CA.'
7. 'Monthly? I'd rather pay once a year and forget about it.'
8. 'What happens if I want to cancel halfway through?'
9. 'Do you cover pre-existing conditions?'
10. 'Send me a proposal and I'll review it.'


AFTER OBJECTION 10, wait for my final response, then stop and wait for me to say END.


AFTER I SAY 'END', drop character completely and give feedback. Be specific, quote my actual
words, no encouragement.


1. THE SCORECARD. Go through all ten. For each, quote my first few words and mark it: ACK if I
acknowledged before answering, EXP if I went straight to explaining, ARG if I argued or
contradicted, Q if I asked a question first. Give me the ten marks in a row.


2. THE COUNT. How many of the ten started with an acknowledgement? How many with an explanation?
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▶ PROMPT — SIM 2 · Rapid fire · Onsurity

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

3. QUESTIONS ASKED. Out of ten. Most people ask zero or one under time pressure. Give the number and quote any I did ask.

4. BEST AND WORST. Quote my strongest response and my weakest, and say what made each one what it was.

5. THE THREE PEOPLE MISHANDLE MOST. Objections 3, 5 and 7 - the contract-staff dismissal, 'insurance is insurance', and the preference for annual payment. Tell me what I did on each. Number 3 in particular: did I correct him, or did I ask about it? Correcting a buyer about his own workforce is a fast way to lose a call.

6. DID I DODGE NUMBER 9? Pre-existing conditions is a direct factual question. Did I answer it plainly or talk around it?

DID I SAY 'BUT'? Count how many times I followed an acknowledgement with 'but'. Quote each one.

—— END OF PROMPT ——

Part 4 — Vyapar

4.1 What you are working with

	Detail
What it is	A billing, invoicing, inventory and accounting app for Indian small businesses. Founded 2016 in Bengaluru, bootstrapped.
The distinctive things	GST-compliant. Works fully offline. Runs on both mobile and desktop.
The commercial model	Free on mobile. Paid tiers unlock desktop access, multi-user billing, advanced inventory, party ledgers, role-based access controls and richer reporting.
Scale	Over a million small businesses use it.
Competitors	Tally — the legacy incumbent most Indian accountants trained on — plus Busy and MyBillBook.
Who buys	Retailers, wholesalers, distributors, pharmacies, grocers, small service businesses. Usually the owner, deciding alone.

THE THING TO REMEMBER ABOUT THIS BUYER

Almost nothing in a small business is framed as a problem. It is framed as how things are. 'Business is fine' is genuinely how they see it.

So objections here are rarely resistance. They are usually a lack of urgency wearing the costume of an objection, and the response to most of them is a question rather than an argument.

They are also deciding alone, with their own money, about something nobody is forcing them to do. Pressure works badly.

4.2 The objection guide

The ten below are the ones you will face in the rapid-fire drill, in that order. Knowing them in advance does not make it easier — fifteen seconds each, and knowing the answer is not the same as being able to say it.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
1. "That's too much for a shop my size."	A value-visibility problem, not affordability. They have not connected the cost to anything.	• Acknowledge that it is a real recurring cost. • Reach for a number they have already given you. • Put the price next to that number, never next to a benefit.	Say the number and stop. Do not soften it or trail off.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
2. "We already use Tally."	Incumbent. Almost never about features — usually about one person who knows how to use it.	• Acknowledge Tally without criticising it. • Find out who actually does the entries. • Explore what happens when that person is unavailable.	Never criticise Tally. Their accountant chose it and you are implying he was wrong.
3. "My son handles all the computer things."	Not an objection — a stakeholder disclosure. Most sellers hear a wall.	• Treat it as useful information, because it is. • Find out what the son says about the current records. • Recognise that he is probably your champion.	Interested, not deflated. This is good news and your voice should say so.
4. "I'm not good with technology."	Real and emotional. About not wanting to look foolish, not about capability.	• Acknowledge without reassuring. • Point at what they are already doing on the app. • Let the evidence do the work.	Warm, no reassurance. 'Don't worry, it's easy' is condescending and they will hear it.
5. "The free version works fine for me."	True, and the hardest here because it is correct.	• Agree genuinely first. Most people never need more. • Find the one limit they have actually hit. • Speak only to that limit. Nothing else.	Agree without qualification. Arguing that free is insufficient insults their judgement.
6. "What if my data gets lost?"	Real risk objection, often from someone who has lost data before.	• Acknowledge the stake — everything about the business is in there. • Find out whether it has happened to them. • Be concrete about where data sits and how it is backed up.	No hand-waving. Vagueness here is fatal.
7. "I don't have time to learn a new system."	Usually timing, sometimes risk. The busy season is a real constraint.	• Concede the timing completely. • Find out when their quiet stretch is. • Tie any start to their calendar, not yours.	Do not try to make now the right time. Conceding is what earns the later date.
8. "My accountant won't accept reports from this."	Authority objection in disguise. The accountant is a real influencer.	• Acknowledge that they do not want to fight their accountant. • Find out what he asks for each quarter. • Offer to deal with him directly.	Treat the accountant as someone to include, never as an obstacle.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
9. "Can you give me a discount?"	Often ritual rather than a real objection. Discounting immediately confirms the price was inflated.	• Acknowledge it lightly — you would ask too. • Test whether price is the actual issue before conceding anything. • Hold the price while you find out.	Friendly and unhurried. No apology for the price, and do not fill the silence after your question.
10. "Let me think about it, I'll call you back."	Polite exit. Nobody calls back.	• Agree without friction. • Find out which part they want to think about. • Recognise that whatever they name is the objection you never handled.	Light and unbothered. Any urgency turns this into a chase.

4.3 Simulation 3 — Conversation: The Wholesaler

	Detail
Who	Rajesh Agarwal, 49, hardware wholesaler in Kanpur. Eight staff, supplies about 60 retailers. Free Vyapar user for two years.
Where you are	He replied to an upgrade prompt asking what the paid version does. This is that call.
Format	One conversation, about eight minutes. Three objections, layering.
Objective	Reach the third objection and respond to what it actually is.
The trap	His third objection is not about the software at all, and nothing in the guide above prepares you for it. That is deliberate.
What this tests	Whether you can handle an objection you have not seen before by using the framework rather than a memorised answer.

▶ PROMPT — SIM 3 · Rajesh Agarwal · Vyapar conversation

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

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You are role-playing a phone call. I work at Vyapar and I am calling you about the paid version.
Stay in character until I say END.


ABOUT VYAPAR. Billing, invoicing, inventory and accounting for Indian small businesses.
GST-compliant, works fully offline, mobile and desktop. Free on mobile; paid tiers add desktop
access, multi-user billing, advanced inventory, party ledgers, ROLE-BASED ACCESS CONTROLS, and
richer reporting.


YOU ARE RAJESH AGARWAL, 49. You run a hardware wholesale business in Kanpur with eight staff,
supplying about sixty retailers. You have used the free Vyapar app for two years for billing. You
clicked an upgrade prompt last week.


HOW TO BEHAVE. Practical, a bit blunt, not unfriendly. One to three sentences per reply. If they
acknowledge before answering, open up slightly. If they explain without acknowledging, stay where
you were. If they push, get shorter.


THREE OBJECTIONS, IN ORDER. Do not move on until the current one is handled - acknowledged and
probed, not explained away.


OBJECTION 1 - THE FREE VERSION.
'The free one works fine. I make my bills, it does what I need. Why would I pay?'
- If they list paid features: unmoved. 'I don't need all that.'
- If they ask what happens on a busy day, or who else bills, or what they cannot currently do:
answer and move on.
- IF ASKED: two of your staff need to bill at the same time in the mornings. Only your phone has
it. The other one writes on paper and it gets entered late, or not at all.


OBJECTION 2 - PAST FAILURE.
'I tried putting a computer system in about six years ago. Spent money on it. My staff wouldn't
use it - they went back to the register within a month. I'm not doing that again.'
- If they say their product is easier: unmoved. 'That's what that fellow said too.'
- If they ask what specifically the staff struggled with, or what the old system was: answer and
move on.
- IF ASKED: it was in English, it needed the computer in the back office, and the counter staff
had to walk away from customers to use it. Nobody trained them properly.


OBJECTION 3 - THE REAL ONE. Say it more reluctantly than the others. This is uncomfortable for
you.
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▶ PROMPT — SIM 3 · Rajesh Agarwal · Vyapar conversation

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

'And there's one more thing. If everything goes into a system and my staff can see it... I give different rates to different parties. Some retailers get better prices than others - that's just how it works. I don't want all of that sitting there for everyone to look at.'

- This is the actual reason you have not upgraded in two years.
- If they dismiss it, or say 'that's not really a problem': go quiet and start closing the call down.
- If they treat it as a legitimate business concern and ask about it - who would need to see what, which staff do what - engage properly.
- Role-based access controls are the answer, but ONLY accept it if they have asked enough to understand your situation first. If they jump straight to naming the feature, say: 'Hmm. Maybe.' and stay unconvinced.
- If handled well, agree to a specific next step and sound relieved that they did not make you feel bad about it.

AFTER I SAY 'END', drop character and give feedback. Specific, quote my words, no encouragement.

1. DID I REACH OBJECTION 3? How long did it take?
2. THE FIRST SENTENCE, THREE TIMES. Quote my first sentence in response to each. Classify each: ACKNOWLEDGEMENT, EXPLANATION, ARGUMENT, or QUESTION.
3. OBJECTION 3 SPECIFICALLY. This one is not in the playbook and is slightly awkward - differential pricing. Did I treat it as a legitimate business reality or did I react to it? Quote exactly what I said. Did I ask about his situation before naming a solution?
4. PROBE COUNT, out of three.
5. THE FINAL ASK. Specific, or vague?
6. DID I SAY 'BUT' after an acknowledgement? Count and quote.

— END OF PROMPT —

4.4 Simulation 4 — Rapid Fire: The Shop Owner

	Detail
Who	A small shop owner. A composite.
Format	Ten objections, one after another, roughly fifteen seconds each. These are the ten in the guide at 4.2.
Objective	Acknowledge before you answer, every time. Ten out of ten.
Difficulty	Individually easy. The difficulty is doing it ten times without slipping into rebuttal.

▸ PROMPT — SIM 4 · Rapid fire · Vyapar

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You are running a rapid-fire objection drill. I work at Vyapar. Stay in character until I say END.

ABOUT VYAPAR. Billing, invoicing, inventory and accounting for Indian small businesses.
GST-compliant, works fully offline, mobile and desktop. Free on mobile; paid tiers add desktop
access, multi-user billing, advanced inventory and richer reporting. Main competitor is Tally.

YOU ARE A SMALL SHOP OWNER in an Indian town. Not hostile - busy, practical, sceptical. Keep every
line short.

HOW THE DRILL WORKS.
- When I say START, fire OBJECTION 1 and nothing else. No preamble.
- I respond. Give ONE short line back in character - a reaction, not an evaluation. Then
immediately fire the next.
- Do NOT coach or score between objections. Stay in character.
- If my response acknowledges you, let it land slightly. If it is a rebuttal or explanation with
no acknowledgement, show it not landing: 'Hmm.' 'Still sounds like a lot.' 'That's what they all
say.'
- Keep moving. About four minutes.

THE TEN OBJECTIONS, in this order.
1. 'How much does it cost? ... That's too much for a shop my size.'
2. 'We already use Tally. Been using it for years.'
3. 'My son handles all the computer things. I don't get involved.'
4. 'I'm not good with technology. I'll never learn this.'
5. 'The free version is working fine for me.'
6. 'What if my data gets lost? Everything is in there.'
7. 'I don't have time to sit and learn a new system.'
8. 'My accountant won't accept reports from this. He has his own way.'
9. 'Can you give me some discount? Everyone gives discount.'
10. 'Let me think about it. I'll call you back.'

AFTER OBJECTION 10, wait for my final response, then stop and wait for me to say END.

AFTER I SAY 'END', drop character completely and give feedback. Be specific, quote my actual
words, no encouragement.

1. THE SCORECARD. Go through all ten. For each, quote my first few words and mark it: ACK if I
acknowledged before answering, EXP if I went straight to explaining, ARG if I argued or
contradicted, Q if I asked a question first. Give me the ten marks in a row.

2. THE COUNT. How many of the ten started with an acknowledgement? How many with an explanation?

3. QUESTIONS ASKED. Out of ten. Most people ask zero or one under time pressure. Give the number
and quote any I did ask.
```

▶ PROMPT — SIM 4 · Rapid fire · Vyapar

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

4. BEST AND WORST. Quote my strongest response and my weakest, and say what made each one what it was.

5. THE ONES PEOPLE ARGUE WITH. Objections 2, 5 and 9 - Tally, the free version, and the discount. Tell me what I did on each.

6. DID I DISCOUNT? On objection 9, did I offer money off, hold the price, or ask a question?

DID I SAY 'BUT'? Count how many times I followed an acknowledgement with 'but'. Quote each one.

—— END OF PROMPT ——

Part 5 — GoKwik

5.1 What you are working with

	Detail
What it is	E-commerce enablement for Indian D2C brands. Founded 2020 in Gurugram. Roughly $68M raised, Series B led by Think Investments.
The products	KwikCheckout — one-click checkout that reduces cart abandonment. RTO Shield — scores every cash-on-delivery order for the risk the customer refuses the parcel, so high-risk orders can be verified, converted to prepaid, or declined before they ship.
The problem	RTO, return to origin. A refused COD parcel goes back to the warehouse. The brand pays shipping both ways and gets nothing. It rarely appears as a line item, so most brands under-count it.
The numbers	COD is typically 40-60% of orders outside metros. RTO runs 15-30% on COD. Each RTO costs roughly Rs 120-250 in shipping and handling, plus blocked inventory. GoKwik claims RTO reduction of 30-50%.
Who buys	Founders, or whoever owns growth and e-commerce. Usually one decision maker, commercially literate, short of time.
Where it does not fit	Below roughly 1,500 orders a month the risk model has too little signal and the commercials do not work for either side.

THE ARITHMETIC IS THE ARGUMENT

COD share × monthly orders × RTO rate × cost per RTO. Four numbers they all have and almost none have multiplied.

Make them do it out loud. If you produce the number they will nod politely and nothing will change. If they produce it themselves they will go quiet, and that silence is the sale.

5.2 The objection guide

The ten below are the ones in the rapid-fire drill, in that order. Three of them are not objections at all — the guide says which.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
1. "We already use Shiprocket. Doesn't this overlap?"	Category confusion, not an incumbent objection. Shipping and RTO prediction are different problems.	• Acknowledge that it is a fair question to ask. • Find out what currently looks at a COD order before it ships. • Draw the distinction in time — before shipping versus after.	Frame it as a difference, not a correction. 'Different thing' beats 'no, actually'.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
2. "What's the pricing? On every order or just flagged ones?"	A genuine commercial question, not an objection.	• Answer it directly and without preamble. • Ask what you need to give an accurate number. • Do not dodge — dodging costs more than any number.	Plainly. Hesitation before a pricing answer reads as something being hidden.
3. "We tried an RTO tool last year. It didn't move the needle."	The most important objection here. Something specific failed and they will not be talked out of it.	• Acknowledge that they already spent money on this and got nothing. • Find out what the tool actually did — flagged, blocked, or scored. • Differ on that specific mechanism. • Never claim to be different in general.	Slower. Claiming to be different is what the last vendor said and they will hear the echo.
4. "My dev team has zero bandwidth. We're mid-replatform."	Usually real. A resourcing objection, not a value objection.	• Concede fully. Do not minimise the integration work. • Find out when the replatform lands. • Tie any start to their date.	Concede completely. Arguing it is small reads as not understanding engineering.
5. "How do I know your model works on my category?"	Proof objection, and fair. They believe you work; not that you work for them.	• Acknowledge that the concern is technically correct. • Get the numbers that make their category specific. • Offer something checkable, not reassurance.	No enthusiasm. Confidence makes a sceptic more sceptical.
6. "Send me a case study and I'll have a look." NOT AN OBJECTION — a polite exit.	Sending one changes nothing. The request is the exit.	• Agree instantly. • Ask one question in the same breath so what you send is specific. • Read their willingness to answer as the real signal.	The question must follow without a pause. A gap between them turns it into a favour.
7. "This isn't a priority this quarter."	Usually true. No forcing event, and manufacturing one will not work.	• Acknowledge it and mean it. • Find out what would make it one. • Set a check-back against that event, not a generic date.	Be genuinely willing to walk. The willingness is what makes them reconsider.
8. "Can you guarantee the reduction? Contractually?"	A risk objection in commercial clothing. They want to know you believe your own numbers.	• Acknowledge what they are really asking — who carries the risk. • Find out what structure would satisfy them.	Unbothered. Flinching tells them you do not believe the numbers either.

The objection	What it usually means	What your response has to do	Delivery
		• Never invent a guarantee you cannot honour.	
9. "I'd need to run this past my co-founder." NOT AN OBJECTION — process information.	How they decide, not resistance. Most sellers push here.	• Treat it as helpful. • Find out what that person will want to know. • Offer to build exactly that.	Relaxed. Pushing past this costs you your only internal ally.
10. "We're probably too small for this, aren't we?" NOT AN OBJECTION — a self-disqualification, often wrong.	The most commonly accepted false no in this document.	• Do not agree before you have checked. • Find out what makes them say it, and get their order volume. • If they are above the threshold, say so plainly. • If genuinely below it, say that honestly and tell them when to come back.	Ask before you agree. Accepting a self-disqualification unchecked is how viable customers get lost.

5.3 Simulation 5 — Conversation: The Burned Champion

	Detail
Who	Neha Bansal, co-founder of a D2C wellness brand. Roughly Rs 25 crore, 35 people, Delhi.
Where you are	She took the call after a referral from another founder. Warm introduction, cold on the category.
Format	One conversation, about eight minutes. Three objections, layering.
Objective	Reach the third objection and propose something that responds to it rather than to the product concern.
The trap	Her third objection is about her, not about the product, and no feature answers it.
What this tests	Whether you can recognise a personal objection and respond to it as one. Selling harder makes it worse.

▸ PROMPT — SIM 5 · Neha Bansal · GoKwik conversation

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

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You are role-playing a phone call. I work at GoKwik and I am calling you after a referral. Stay in character until I say END.


ABOUT GOKWIK. E-commerce enablement for Indian D2C brands. KwikCheckout reduces cart abandonment. RTO Shield scores COD orders for refusal risk before they ship, so high-risk orders can be verified, converted to prepaid, or declined. RTO means return to origin - a refused COD parcel where the brand pays shipping both ways and gets nothing.


YOU ARE NEHA BANSAL, co-founder of a D2C wellness brand. About Rs 25 crore a year, 35 people, Delhi. Another founder referred this call. You are polite because of the referral, not because you are interested.


HOW TO BEHAVE. Sharp, courteous, a little tired of vendors. One to three sentences per reply. If they acknowledge before answering, soften slightly. If they explain without acknowledging, stay where you were. If they push, get cooler.


THREE OBJECTIONS, IN ORDER. Do not move on until the current one is handled - acknowledged and probed, not explained away.


OBJECTION 1 - PAST FAILURE.
'We tried an RTO tool about eighteen months ago. It didn't do anything. Our numbers looked exactly the same after three months.'
- If they say they are better or different: unmoved. 'Everyone says that.'
- If they ask what the tool actually did - flagged, blocked, scored - answer and move on.
- IF ASKED: it flagged risky orders in a dashboard nobody looked at. It did not stop anything. Nobody on the team had time to action the flags.


OBJECTION 2 - THE INTERNAL BLOCKER.
'My tech lead is also very against anything sitting on our checkout. He's had bad experiences with third-party scripts slowing pages down.'
- If they dismiss the tech lead's concern, or say it is not an issue: get cooler. 'He'd disagree with you.'
- If they ask what specifically happened, or what would satisfy him: answer and move on.
- IF ASKED: a marketing pixel added 1.8 seconds to page load last year and conversion dropped for a fortnight before anyone worked out why.


OBJECTION 3 - THE REAL ONE. Say it more directly and more personally than the others.
```

▶ PROMPT — SIM 5 · Neha Bansal · GoKwik conversation

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

'I'll be honest with you about where I actually am. I'm the one who pushed for that last tool. I championed it internally, I got the budget, and it did nothing. That was eighteen months ago and people still bring it up. I'm not in a hurry to be the person who backs another one of these.'

- This is the real objection and it is about her, not about the product. No feature answers it.
- If they respond by explaining why GoKwik is better: go quiet. 'Mm. Maybe.' Start closing the call down.
- If they respond by pitching harder, or listing customers: end the call politely.
- If they acknowledge what she has actually said - that the risk here is personal and reputational, not technical - engage.
- What works: anything that makes this NOT her decision alone, or small and reversible, or measurable in a way that is not her word against theirs. A pilot she does not have to defend. Involving the tech lead directly. A test with a pre-agreed number.
- If they offer something like that, agree, and sound relieved.

AFTER I SAY 'END', drop character and give feedback. Specific, quote my words, no encouragement.

1. DID I REACH OBJECTION 3? How long did it take?
2. THE FIRST SENTENCE, THREE TIMES. Quote my first sentence to each objection. Classify each: ACKNOWLEDGEMENT, EXPLANATION, ARGUMENT, or QUESTION.
3. OBJECTION 3 SPECIFICALLY. She told you the risk was personal, not technical. Did I respond to that, or did I respond with product? Quote exactly what I said next. If I explained why GoKwik is better, say plainly that I answered a concern she did not raise.
4. DID I MAKE IT SMALLER OR SAFER? Did I propose anything that reduced her personal exposure - a pilot, a pre-agreed measure, involving the tech lead? Or did I propose the same thing she had already been burned by?
5. PROBE COUNT, out of three.
6. DID I SAY 'BUT' after an acknowledgement? Count and quote.

—— END OF PROMPT ——

5.4 Simulation 6 — Rapid Fire: The Founder

	Detail
Who	A D2C founder. Commercially sharp, fast, used to being sold to.
Format	Ten objections, one after another, fifteen seconds each. These are the ten in the guide at 5.2.
Objective	Acknowledge before answering, and ask at least three questions across the ten.
Difficulty	The hardest drill. Three of these are not objections, and one is the buyer disqualifying himself incorrectly.

▸ PROMPT — SIM 6 · Rapid fire · GoKwik

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

```
You are running a rapid-fire objection drill. I work at GoKwik. Stay in character until I say END.

ABOUT GOKWIK. E-commerce enablement for Indian D2C brands. KwikCheckout reduces cart abandonment. RTO Shield scores COD orders for refusal risk before they ship. RTO means return to origin - a refused COD parcel where the brand pays shipping both ways and gets nothing.

YOU ARE A D2C FOUNDER. Commercially sharp, fast, used to being sold to. Not rude, but no patience for anything rehearsed. Keep every line short.

HOW THE DRILL WORKS.
- When I say START, fire OBJECTION 1 and nothing else. No preamble.
- I respond. Give ONE short line back in character - a reaction, not an evaluation. Then immediately fire the next.
- Do NOT coach or score between objections. Stay in character.
- If my response acknowledges you or asks something useful, let it land. If it is a rebuttal or a feature claim, show it not landing: 'Right.' 'Everyone says that.' 'Sure.'
- Keep moving. About four minutes.

THE TEN OBJECTIONS, in this order.
1. 'We're already using Shiprocket for logistics. Doesn't this overlap?'
2. 'What's the pricing? ... And is that on every order or just the flagged ones?'
3. 'We tried an RTO tool last year. It didn't move the needle at all.'
4. 'My dev team has zero bandwidth. We're mid-replatform.'
5. 'How do I know your model works on my category? Everyone trains on fashion.'
6. 'Send me a case study and I'll have a look.'
7. 'This isn't really a priority for us this quarter.'
8. 'Can you guarantee the reduction? Contractually?'
9. 'I'd need to run this past my co-founder anyway.'
10. 'Honestly, we're probably too small for this, aren't we?'

THREE OF THESE ARE NOT OBJECTIONS - react accordingly if I spot it.
- Number 6 is a polite exit. If I agree and then ask one question so the case study is relevant, let it land. If I just say yes and move on, be visibly done.
- Number 9 is information about how you decide. If I treat it as a brush-off and push, get cooler. If I ask what your co-founder would want to know, engage.
- Number 10 is you disqualifying yourself wrongly - you do about 6,000 orders a month, well within range. If I accept it and back off, say nothing and let the drill end flatly. If I ask what makes you say that, or ask your volume, tell me the number.

AFTER OBJECTION 10, wait for my final response, then stop and wait for me to say END.

AFTER I SAY 'END', drop character completely and give feedback. Be specific, quote my actual words, no encouragement.
```

▶ PROMPT — SIM 6 · Rapid fire · GoKwik

Copy everything inside this box. Paste into a new chat. Turn on voice mode. Say START.

1. THE SCORECARD. Go through all ten. For each, quote my first few words and mark it: ACK if I acknowledged before answering, EXP if I went straight to explaining, ARG if I argued or contradicted, Q if I asked a question first. Give me the ten marks in a row.

2. THE COUNT. How many of the ten started with an acknowledgement? How many with an explanation?

3. QUESTIONS ASKED. Out of ten. Most people ask zero or one under time pressure. Give the number and quote any I did ask.

4. BEST AND WORST. Quote my strongest response and my weakest, and say what made each one what it was.

5. THE THREE THAT WERE NOT OBJECTIONS. What did I do on numbers 6, 9 and 10, and did I recognise each for what it was? Number 10 is the important one - if I agreed they were too small, tell me plainly that I disqualified a viable customer on their own incorrect assumption, and that one question would have fixed it.

6. THE PAST FAILURE. On number 3, did I ask what specifically did not work, or did I claim to be different? Claiming to be different never works - it is exactly what the last vendor said.

DID I SAY 'BUT'? Count how many times I followed an acknowledgement with 'but'. Quote each one.

— END OF PROMPT —

Part 6 — Prep and Log

6.1 The two-minute prep, before each simulation

	Do this
1	Pick the three objections you are most likely to get. Write your acknowledgement for each, out loud, in your own words. The guide gives you what the response must do — the sentence is yours.
2	Write one probe question per objection. One. If you write three, you will ask none.
3	Read your acknowledgements aloud and time them. Longer than eight seconds and it is an argument, not an acknowledgement.
4	Decide in advance what you will do if they ask for a discount. Deciding during a call means giving one.
5	Close this document. Reading from a playbook is audible.

6.2 Conversations — Simulations 1, 3 and 5

	Sim 1 (Vikram)	Sim 3 (Rajesh)	Sim 5 (Neha)
Did I reach objection 3? How long?			
First sentence classification: obj 1 / 2 / 3			
Probe count, out of 3			
Was my final ask proportionate?			
'But' count			

6.3 Drills — Simulations 2, 4 and 6

Copy the ten marks straight from the feedback. Do not clean them up.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	ACK	Q	'But'
Sim 2 (Onsurity)													
Sim 4 (Vyapar)													
Sim 6 (GoKwik)													

6.4 After all six

Question	Your answer
Across the thirty rapid-fire objections, how many did you open with an acknowledgement?	
How many questions did you ask across the thirty? Most people manage two or three.	
In the three conversations, how many times did you reach the third objection?	
Which objection type did you argue with most — price, incumbent, past failure, or the polite exit?	
Write out, word for word, the response you are least happy with. Then write what you would say now.	

THE TWO THINGS TO LOOK AT

THE QUESTION COUNT. Across thirty objections under time pressure, most people ask two or three, because asking a question when someone has just pushed back feels like losing ground. It is the opposite — every question buys you the information to answer the objection they actually have.

THE THIRD OBJECTION. In all three conversations the real reason was the last thing said, and in two of them it was not about the product at all — a wholesaler who does not want his staff seeing his margins, and a founder who does not want to back another failure. No feature answers either. If you reached the third objection in fewer than two of the three, you are answering questions instead of finding them.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT CANNOT GIVE YOU

Every line you could write from this guide is available to the buyer's last three vendors as well. The words are not the advantage — which is why the guide does not give you any.

What separates people is whether they can stay still for three seconds while someone is unhappy with them, ask one question instead of defending, and then stop talking.

That is not knowledge. It is a physical habit, and the only way to get it is to do it badly a number of times out loud.